

HOUSE No. 694

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Adam J. Scanlon

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to preserve local control of Chapter 74 admissions policies.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Adam J. Scanlon</i>	<i>14th Bristol</i>	<i>1/7/2025</i>
<i>Steven George Xiarhos</i>	<i>5th Barnstable</i>	<i>3/15/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>7/10/2025</i>
<i>John J. Marsi</i>	<i>6th Worcester</i>	<i>5/7/2026</i>

HOUSE No. 694

By Representative Scanlon of North Attleborough, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 694) of Adam J. Scanlon relative to admissions policies for vocational schools. Education.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to preserve local control of Chapter 74 admissions policies.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 1 of Chapter 74 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
2 Official Edition, is hereby amended by striking, in line 9, the following words:-

3 “conditions of admission of student,”

4 SECTION 2. Section 7 of Chapter 74 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
5 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting, after the word “board,” in line 8, the following
6 words:-

7 “provided that such admission would be in accordance with requirements for admission
8 established pursuant to Section 3 and Section 59 of this chapter,”

9 SECTION 3. Section 5 of Chapter 74 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
10 Official Edition, is hereby amended by adding the following words:-

11 “Requirements for admission to an independent vocational-technical school established
12 pursuant to Section 4 of this chapter shall be determined by the district trustees for such an
13 independent vocational-technical school. Changes to duly established requirements for
14 admission to such an independent vocational-technical school shall be made by a majority vote
15 of the district trustees and may be made only after at least one public hearing , held at least thirty
16 days after the proposed change to admission requirements has been made public, and at which
17 the public may offer remarks. Notice of the time and place of said public hearing, and of the
18 availability for review of the proposed change to admission requirements shall be provided to
19 each person who has previously requested the receipt of such notices from the district trustees, as
20 well as to individuals and organizations known to the district trustees to have an interest in issues
21 related to vocational-technical education.”

22 SECTION 4. Chapter 74 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding a new
23 section:-

24 Section 59. (a) Requirements for admission to a vocational-technical school established
25 pursuant to Section 3 of this chapter shall be determined by the board of trustees for the
26 vocational-technical school or, if there is no such board of trustees, the school committee of the
27 municipality. Changes to duly established requirements for admission to such a vocational-
28 technical school shall be made by a majority vote of the district trustees and may be made only
29 after at least one public hearing, held at least thirty days after the proposed change to admission
30 requirements has been made public, and at which the public may offer remarks. Notice of the
31 time and place of said public hearing, and of the availability for review of the proposed change to
32 admission requirements shall be provided to each person who has previously requested the
33 receipt of such notices from the board of trustees for the vocational-technical school or, if there

is no such board of trustees, the school committee, as well as to individuals and organizations known to the board of trustees for the vocational-technical school or, if there is no such board of trustees, the school committee to have an interest in issues related to vocational-technical education.

(b) Requirements for admission to an independent vocational-technical school established pursuant to Section 5A of this chapter shall be determined by the board of regional school district trustees for vocational-technical education, pursuant to Section 5A, for such a vocational-technical school. Changes to duly established requirements for admission to such an independent vocational-technical school shall be made by a majority vote of the district trustees and may be made only after at least one public hearing, held at least thirty days after the proposed change to admission requirements has been made public, and at which the public may offer remarks. Notice of the time and place of said public hearing, and of the availability for review of the proposed change to admission requirements shall be provided to each person who has previously requested the receipt of such notices from the board of regional school district trustees for vocational-technical education, as well as to individuals and organizations known to the board of regional school district trustees for vocational-technical education to have an interest in issues related to vocational-technical education.”